Sayeed Salahudeen as a specially designated global terrorist by the United States just before Modi's visit was greatly appreciated by New Delhi, as it strengthened its resolve to take on militancy in the Kashmir Valley. India, for its part, joined the United States in expressing concern regarding North Korea's "destabilising pursuit of nuclear and ballistic missile programs" and pledged to work together to counter the Democratic People's Republic of Korea's (DPRK) weapons of mass destruction programs, "including by holding accountable all parties that support these programs."[36]

Modi has time and again made it clear that he recognises the importance of America in meeting India's developmental and strategic interests. This time too, he underlined that India "considers the US its primary partner for (its) social and economic transformation."[37] In September 2018, the Modi government took the decisive action of signing the long-pending Communications Compatibility and Security Agreement (COMCASA), which will enable the transfer of communication security equipment from the United States to India, facilitating "interoperability" between the two defence forces, as well as with other militaries that use US-origin systems for secured data links. While critics in India see this as a repudiation of India's non-aligned foreign policy posture, Modi has had no hesitation in proclaiming the obvious without the diffidence of the past governments. Embracing America wholeheartedly, as Modi has done during his years in office, is still a considerable political risk in India. But that is the road Modi is willing to traverse. From Obama to Trump, it has been a long road, but Modi's success lies in making the journey fruitful for both sides even as the destination remains firmly in sight.

This doesn't mean that challenges in Indo–US relations have disappeared. There's the persistent Iran question, which has come to the fore with the United States asking all